Lessons Learned Harvester

Finds the lesson that has now been learned four times, which is the only kind worth acting on.

What is Cowork?

The part of Microsoft 365 Copilot that **does the work**, not just the chatting. It reads your mail, files and meetings, then prepares the result. By default it asks you before it sends anything.

What a skill is

One file you upload once. It teaches Cowork a job you keep repeating, so you stop explaining it every time. It lives in your own OneDrive.

What this one gives you

Pulls recurring problems out of close-out reports, retrospectives and project correspondence into a themed register showing which lesson keeps repeating across projects.

1. Download the file for this skill
2. In Cowork, open **Customize**
3. Go to the **Skills** tab
4. **Add** → **Upload skill**, pick the file
5. Start a **new** chat and say the words below

Then just say one of these

- *"What keeps going wrong across projects?"*
- *"Pull the lessons from the close-outs"*
- *"What have we learned more than once?"*

What you get back

- Themes, and how many separate projects hit each one
- The lessons recurring across three projects or more
- Where the same recommendation keeps being made

What it will never do without asking you

- Never attribute a lesson to a named individual. Lessons attach to projects and processes.
- Never state a cause the source material does not state.
- Never rewrite a recommendation into something stronger than what was written.

THE RULE IT FOLLOWS

One project's lessons are not a register.

YOU NEED
Microsoft 365 Copilot with Cowork switched on by your admin. It is off by default.

NOT ON MOBILE
Uploaded skills only work on a laptop or desktop.

IT IS METERED
Cowork bills on usage. Your admin can cap what you spend.

MAKE IT YOURS
Open *references/config.md* to set the names and thresholds.

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